

MAGGIE KE LIYE KUCH BHI!

A comic jugaad stealth game: one power cut, one strict warden, one plate of Maggi.

Game proposal · IIT-H Game Jam

Themes: **Comic** · **Twist** · **Light**

Platform: web browser (desktop + phone)

THE PITCH

It is 1:30 AM, the night before the Endsem. The hostel is under curfew, the main gate has been chained shut since 11, and you have not eaten since lunch. Then the whole block goes dark: **load-shedding**. Somewhere outside the gate, Bhaiya's night canteen is still boiling Maggi, and it closes at 3. Sneak out of your room, down the wing, past the warden's torch and through the gate using nothing but what a hostel has lying around. Don't get caught.

"Kaun hai wahan?! Lights off ka matlab sona hai, ghoomna nahi!" — Warden Saab, every night

HOW IT HITS ALL THREE THEMES

LIGHT

The darkness is your cover. The warden's torch beam is his line of sight, and you can see it sweep the corridor. Your own light sources (a phone torch, the glow of a mosquito bat, a laptop screen) let you search and pick locks, but they give you away too. The game is also light-hearted: nobody gets hurt and the worst punishment is embarrassment.

COMIC

Toon-shaded 3D with thick ink outlines. Sound-effect bubbles pop up in the world ("KHATAK!", "DHADAAM!", "SLURRRP"), speech bubbles over characters, and comic-panel cutscenes. Every character is a hostel stereotype: the warden, the sleeping chowkidar, the topper who never sleeps, the senior who "knows a shortcut".

TWIST

Halfway through the night, **the power comes back**. Tube lights flood every corridor and the rules flip: darkness no longer hides you, so you have to hide in plain sight among students cramming in the corridors, or jugaad the power off again. The final twist: you reach the canteen and the warden is already there, eating Maggi.

CORE LOOP

- **Explore in the dark.** First-person movement with crouch, a run that makes noise, and searching cupboards, bags, bathrooms and the common room.
- **Collect and combine jugaad.** Items have properties, not jobs. A bobby pin and a geometry-box compass make a lock pick. A charger cable lowers keys from a balcony. A bucket and mug are a noise trap. Every lock can be beaten at least two ways.
- **Avoid the warden.** He patrols with a torch and listens for noise. His beam fills a "spotted" meter. If it fills, you are marched back to your room and he takes whatever you were holding.
- **Create distractions.** Set a phone alarm in someone else's room, ring the corridor bell, or knock over a cycle in the parking lot.
- **Score it.** The end card lists every jugaad you used and gives you a Jugaad Score and a title ("Maggi Mastermind", "Curfew Ka Baap"). Improvised answers score more than keys, and keys score more than brute force.

THE ROUTE OUT

Obstacle	Some of the jugaad ways
Your room (roommate locked it from outside "for your own good")	Slide a newspaper under the door and push the key out of the lock, or reach the latch through the vent with a hanger
Wing grill gate (padlock)	Bobby pin + compass pick, or the spare key in the warden's key box (the code is on a sticky note in his diary)
Main gate (chain + chowkidar asleep holding the keys)	Hook the keys off his belt with a hanger and a ruler, or cut through the canteen backyard via a broken wall (loud)

THE TWIST, IN DETAIL

Act 1 — Andhera (dark): stealth in darkness. The warden's torch is the only threat, and light is your risk as well as your tool. **Act 2 — Bijli Aa Gayi (power's back):** it triggers when you open the wing gate. Lights come on everywhere, twenty students come out to study, and the warden can now see the whole corridor. You can either *hide in plain sight* (pick up a textbook, sit with a group-study circle, act like you're cramming while he walks past) or *bring the darkness back* by plugging an electric kettle, an iron and a room heater into one extension board until the fuse trips. That's loud and gets the whole block shouting at you. **Ending:** you reach the canteen and the warden is sitting there with a plate of Maggi. He looks up, then pushes a second plate towards you: "*Paper kal hai na? Jaldi kha, phir so ja.*"

SCOPE (WHAT I WILL SHIP)

- One hostel block: rooms, a wing corridor, the common room, washrooms, stairs, the gate and the canteen.
- One warden AI (patrol, torch cone, hearing, search), plus the sleeping chowkidar and study-circle NPCs.
- About 15 jugaad items, 3 locked obstacles with 2 or more solutions each, and 4 distractions.
- Both acts with the power-flip twist, an opening and ending as comic-panel cutscenes, and the score card.
- Keyboard and mouse plus touch controls, playable in the browser with no install.

Stretch goals: random item placement per run, a second warden route, Hindi/English toggle for the dialogue.

TECH & ART

- **Engine:** plain JavaScript + Three.js, a static site with no build step, deployed on Vercel.
- **Look:** low-poly toon shading with an outline pass, high-contrast lighting (one torch beam in the dark), and comic halftone overlays.
- **Audio:** synthesized footsteps, ceiling fans, a generator hum and the warden's muttering, with sound-effect bubbles shown alongside each sound.
- **Testing:** the warden AI and the lock rules are pure functions with automated tests, so every lock always has a working solution.

PLAN

Phase	Work
Phase 1	Hostel layout and collision, movement, darkness and torch lighting, warden patrol and sight cone
Phase 2	Items, inventory and combining, the three obstacles, distractions, spotted meter and getting caught
Phase 3	The Act 2 power-flip, hide-in-plain-sight, fuse trip, cutscenes, comic sound-effect bubbles, audio
Phase 4	Phone controls, playtesting and balancing, score card, polish, deploy

BUILT FROM SCRATCH · AI USE DISCLOSURE

All game code will be written from scratch during the jam, with no code reused from earlier projects. The only third-party code is the open-source Three.js library. All 3D models, sounds and art will be made during the jam.

AI disclosure: I used Claude (Anthropic) to help brainstorm the concept and to draft and lay out this proposal. During development I will use Claude Code as a coding assistant. I review and test everything it produces, and I am responsible for it. The README will keep an up-to-date log of where AI was used (code, art, audio, writing).

TEAM (SOLO)

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